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Fishery Notice

Category(s): AQUACULTURE - Shellfish

Subject: FN0870-SANITARY - Area 17 - Emergency Closure for Bivalve Shellfish near Ladysmith, Subarea 17-7

The Ladysmith WWTP has reported a sample of their treated effluent that was above the threshold established for the safe harvest of bivalve shellfish. Effective August 18 under the Ladysmith Conditional Management Plan, the following Emergency Closure, prohibiting bivalve shellfish harvest for any purpose, is now in place in the following area:

The Conditionally Restricted areas within Sanitary Closure 17.1 in Ladysmith Harbour have reverted to CLOSED status. Licensed depuration and relay are now suspended by license condition in the Conditionally Restricted area described as:

That portion of Ladysmith Harbour inside a line that starts at an unnamed point of land at 48°58.97' north latitude and 123°46.37' west longitude northwest of Sharpe Point, thence westerly to a point in water at 48°59.02' north latitude and 123°47.03' west longitude, thence northerly to a point on land in Sibell Bay at 48°59.57' north latitude and 123°46.88' west longitude, thence following the shoreline along the high water mark to the point of commencement. [NAD 83]

and

That portion of Ladysmith Harbour inside a line that starts at a point of land at Hunter Point at 48°59.51' north latitude and 123°47.18' west longitude, thence southwesterly to a point on land on the islet off the westernmost end of the easternmost Dunsmuir Island at 48°59.45' north latitude and 123°47.28' west longitude, thence following the northern shoreline high water mark of the westernmost Dunsmuir Island to the westernmost point at 48°59.59' north latitude and 123°47.73' west longitude, thence easterly to a point in water at 48°59.61' north latitude and 123°47.51' west longitude, thence northerly to an unnamed point of land at 48°59.80' north latitude and 123°47.78' west longitude, thence following the shoreline along the high water mark to the point of commencement. [NAD 83]

and

That portion of Ladysmith Harbour inside a line that starts at a point of land at 48°58.71' north latitude and 123°47.92' west longitude, thence northerly to a point in water at 48°58.94' north latitude and 123°47.77' west longitude, thence northwesterly to a point in water at 48°59.12' north latitude and 123°48.04' west longitude thence westerly to a point on land at 48°59.13' north latitude and 123°48.38' west longitude, thence following the shoreline along the high water mark to the point of commencement. [NAD 83] [Sanitary Closure Map 17.1]

Note that this notice does not describe other sanitary closures which may be in effect, or Paralytic Shellfish Poisoning (PSP, red tide) and other marine biotoxin closures. For an area to be open and safe for harvesting, both biotoxin and sanitary need to be open. For information on sanitary contamination and biotoxin closures please go to the Fisheries and Oceans Canada mapping site SHELLI to determine where there is safe harvest at https://gisp.dfo-mpo.gc.ca/Html5Viewer/Index.html?viewer=CSSP_Public_En_Site&locale=en.

Specific species limits, restrictions and maps for each subarea are available at <https://www.pac.dfo-mpo.gc.ca/fm-gp/rec/bc-zones-cb-eng.html> and at local DFO offices.

For more information contact a local DFO office or DFOPAC.CSSP-PCAMPAC.MPO@dfo-mpo.gc.ca.

Fisheries & Oceans Operations Center - FN0870
Sent August 18, 2023 at 1656

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